

BACKCOUNTRY · INTERNAL TOOL



An internal home for employee-generated content — where the Backcountry herd makes gear content that actually sounds like us.

PRODUCT WALKTHROUGH

WORKING PROTOTYPE

AUGUST 2026

Product design & full-stack build

OVERVIEW

One hub for the whole content loop

Herd Hub replaces scattered DMs and shared drives with a single, on-brand home where Backcountry employees get briefed, create, deliver, and get paid for short-form gear content — all in the company's own voice and look.

ROLE

Product design + full-stack build (solo)

STACK

Next.js 16 · TypeScript · Tailwind · SQLite

SCOPE

~40 screens across 6 feature areas

STATUS

Working prototype, iterating with stakeholders

Project pipeline

Idea generator

Multi-creator projects

Payouts & finance export

Upcoming Adventures

Profiles, roles & HR

Top Performers & Library

WHY IT EXISTS

The people who live in the gear make the best content

Herd Hub gives that work a place to get briefed, made, and celebrated — one internal hub instead of a dozen group chats.

1

Beat the blank page

Briefs, deadlines, and an idea generator grounded in the real FW26 line make "what should I make?" effortless.

2

Run the business side

Assignments, payouts, and a finance-ready payments list — not just the creative vibes.

3

Feel like Backcountry

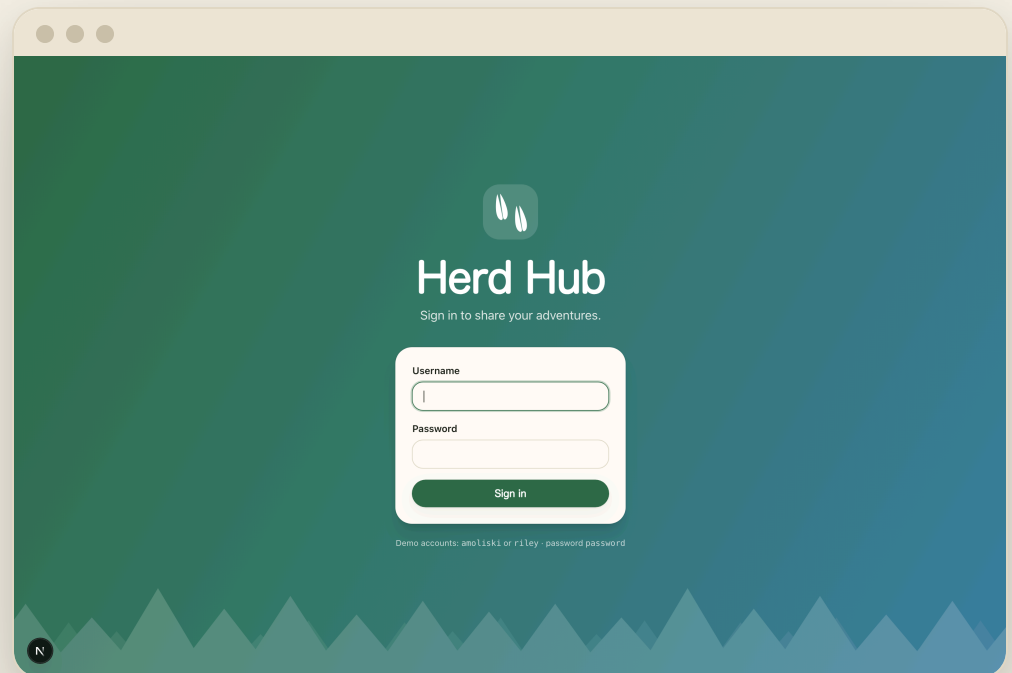
Warm paper, pine green, an evergreen treeline. A community, not a generic dashboard.

FIRST IMPRESSION

A welcome, not a login wall

The front door leads with the brand and an invitation — "sign in to share your adventures" — over the pine treeline. Sign-in is intentionally simple for the prototype; real Backcountry SSO is the planned next step.

The first screen should feel like Backcountry, not a corporate portal.

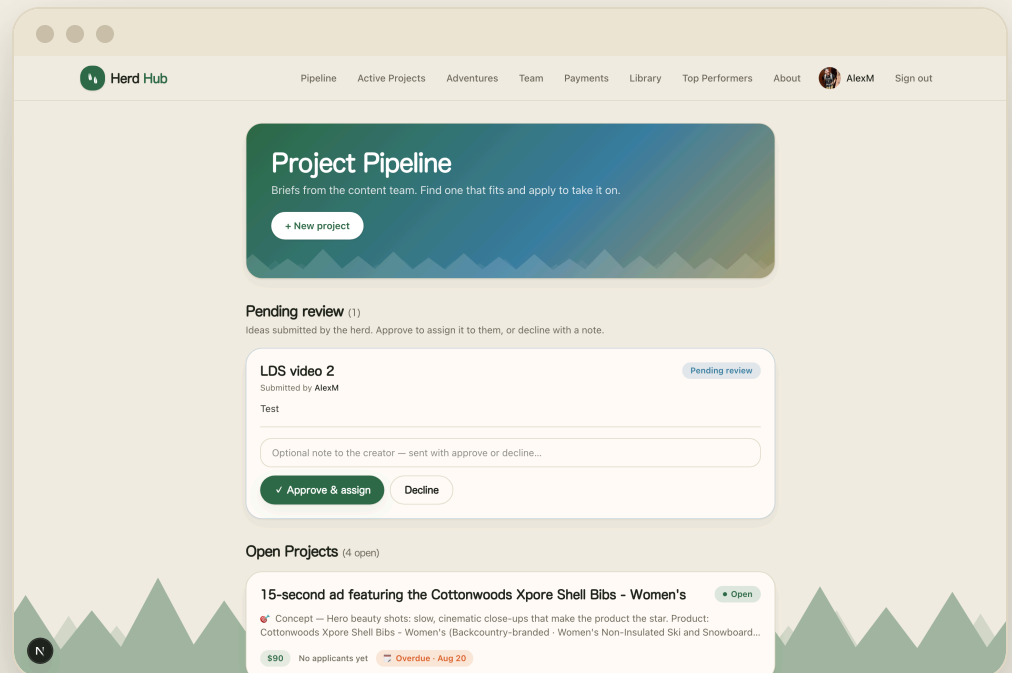


THE CORE LOOP

The Project Pipeline

Every brief in one place — each tagged Open or Assigned, with a payout, deadline, and applicant count. Creators find one that fits and apply; admins assign and track it through. Creators can pitch their own ideas, too.

Status at a glance, so nothing stalls or gets double-claimed.



BEAT THE BLANK PAGE

A brief that writes the first draft

Each brief spells out the concept, hero product, and angle — and can spin up a ready-to-shoot 15-second ad idea built from the real FW26 catalog, weighted so priority products surface.

Creators never start cold, and the content supports what the business is pushing.

The screenshot shows a web application interface for 'Herd Hub'. The top navigation bar includes links for Pipeline, Active Projects, Adventures, Team, Payments, Library, Top Performers, About, and a user profile for AlexM with a Sign out option. The main content area is titled 'New project' with a 'Back to projects' link. A 'Generate an idea for me' button is at the top of the form. The form fields are as follows:

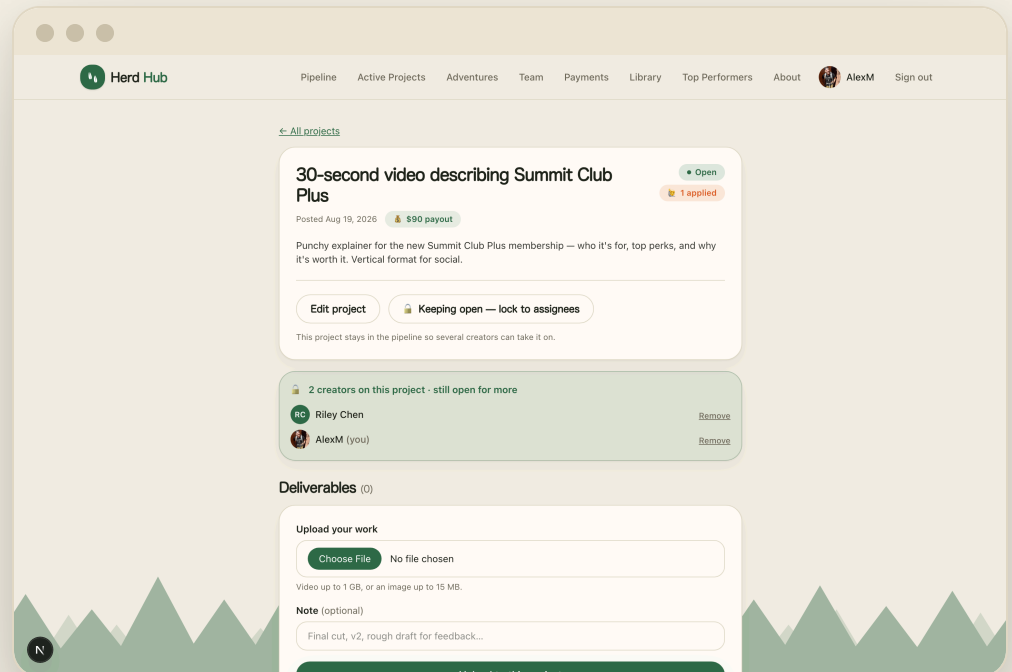
- Project title:** 15-second ad featuring the Venture Daily Pant - Women's
- Brief:**
 - Concept — Before / after: show the moment things change once the product shows up.
 - Product: Venture Daily Pant - Women's (Backcountry-branded - Women's Hiking and Climbing Pants)
 - Hero angle: stretch and durability, all day
 - Setting: a rocky trail on a bluebird day
 - Script (15s, vertical 9:16)
 - 0-3s - Hook: Start mid-action — no logo, no intro, just motion. Set it in a rocky trail on a bluebird day.
 - 3-7s - Tension: show the challenge the Venture Daily Pant - Women's is about to solve.
 - 7-12s - Payoff: reveal the Venture Daily Pant - Women's and show how it "stretch and durability, all day".
 - 12-15s - CTA: on-screen text "Gear up before your next trip." over a clean product beauty shot.
- Example (optional):**
 - Paste a link to a reference (TikTok, Drive, etc.)
 - Buttons: Choose File, No file chosen
 - Text: Paste a link and/or attach a file to show creators what you're looking for.

NEW OPERATIONS

Multiple creators, clear payouts

Admins can keep a brief open in the pipeline while it's already assigned, so several creators can take on the same project. Every project carries a payout — default \$90, higher when it counts — shown from the brief all the way to finance.

One popular brief becomes many pieces of content, without losing track of who's owed what.

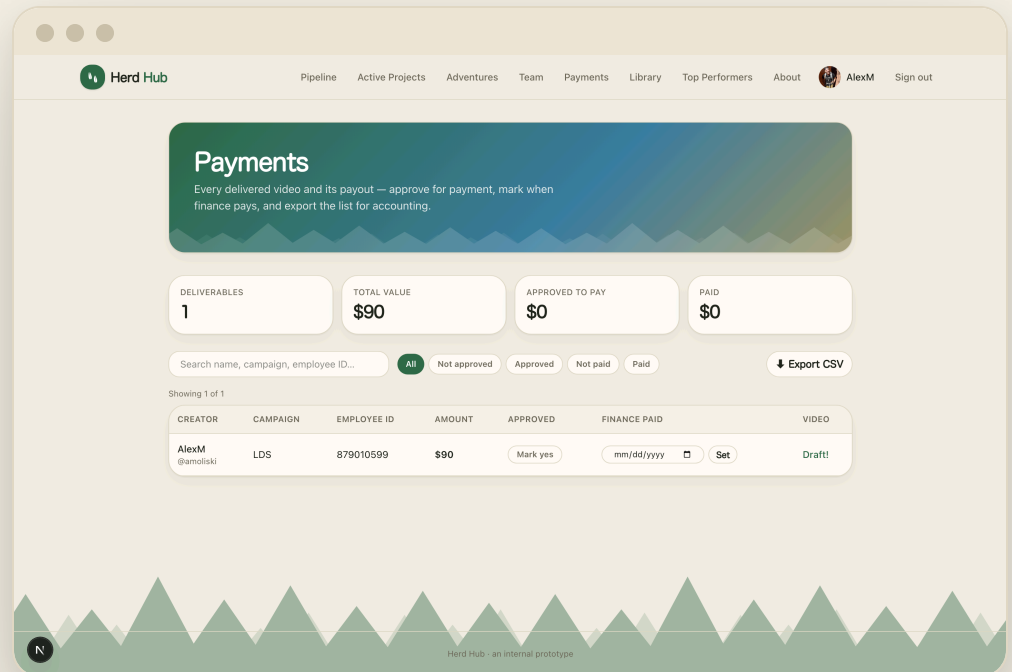


NEW FINANCE

Payments, ready for accounting

One line per delivered video — creator, employee ID, campaign, and amount — with controls to approve for payment and log when finance pays. Search, filter, and one-click CSV export replace the hand-kept spreadsheet.

The finance handoff that used to live in a spreadsheet now lives with the work.

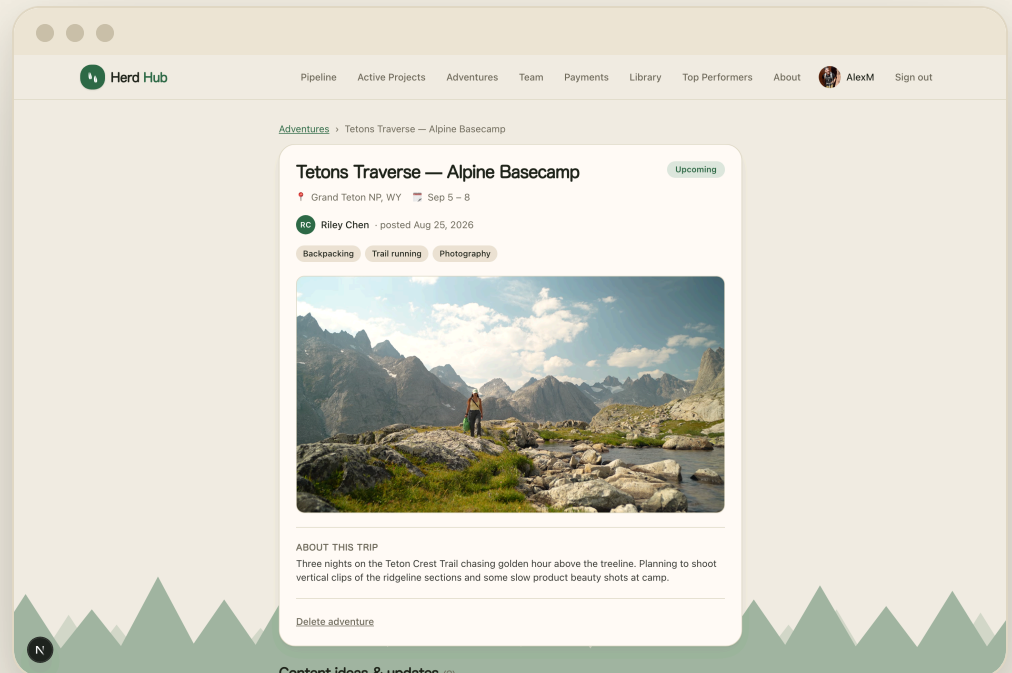


NEW COMMUNITY

Upcoming Adventures

Creators post the trips they're planning — location, dates, and a cover photo or video of the area — and the team follows along and drops content ideas right on the trip. "I'm headed to the Tetons" turns into briefed, on-brand content.

The best content starts with where people are already going.

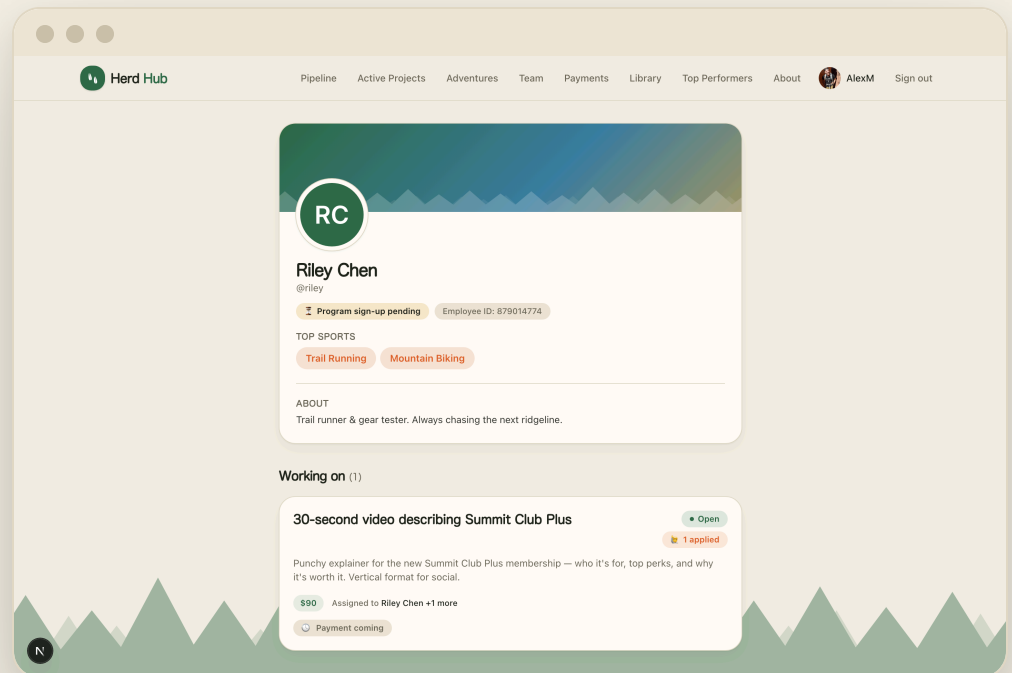


THE HERD

Identity, roles & the HR bits

Every member gets a profile — photo, sports, and a gallery of their work. Admins manage roles, reset access, set employee IDs, and confirm each creator has signed the program agreement, so operations and payroll have what they need.

Recognition drives participation; the admin plumbing keeps it compliant.

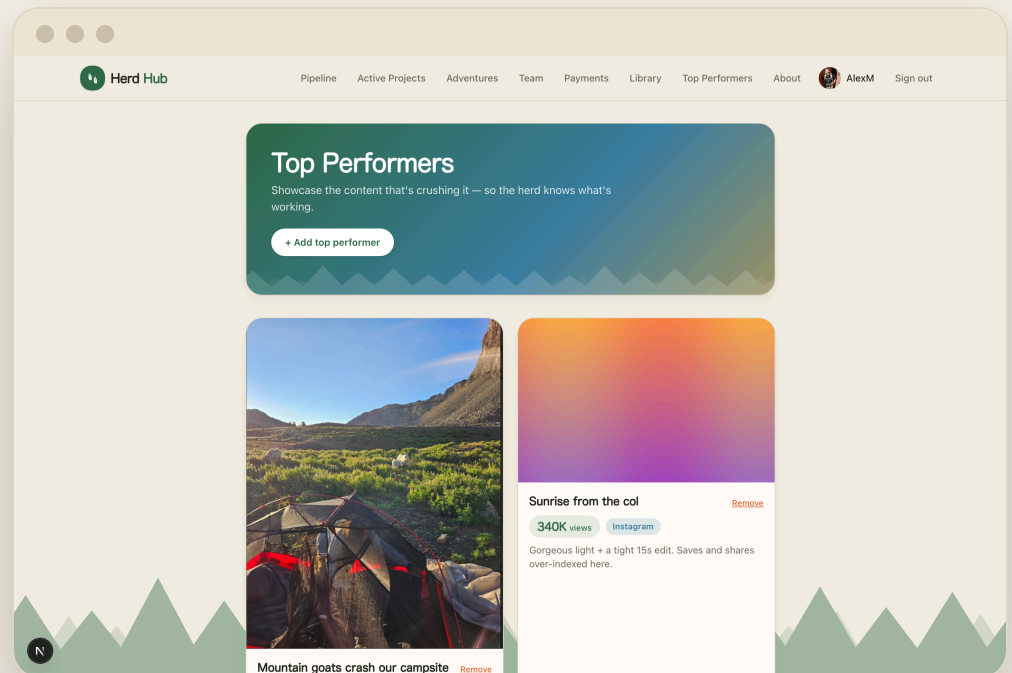


RAISE THE BAR

Show great, teach great

Top Performers celebrates the content that's crushing it with real view counts. A private Content Library gives admins every approved deliverable in one place, and an About guide onboards new members with best-in-class short-form examples.

A living highlight reel sets the standard better than any rulebook.



WHERE IT'S HEADED

From prototype to daily tool

The prototype is fully usable today on a local machine. Three steps turn it into something the whole team can rely on.



Hosting

Move storage off local files (SharePoint is on the table) so the herd can reach it from anywhere.



Real SSO

Swap demo accounts for Backcountry single sign-on, so everyone logs in with their existing account.



AI ideas

Upgrade the idea generator from templated to genuinely AI-written — the catalog data is already real.

Built with the herd's voice in mind — ready for the next ridgeline.